

Ryan Lai

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EDUCATION

University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia

Feb 2024 – Present

- Bachelor of Commerce (Finance and Business Analytics)
- Relevant Course Work: International Business Finance, Behavioural Finance, Quant Business Analytics, Programming for Data Analytics, Portfolio Management, Wealth Management.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

TOTO Ltd., FP&A Intern

Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

- Built and maintained budget and forecast schedule across 2 cost centres, extracting and validating source data from SAP ERP.
- Ran monthly actual versus budget variance analysis, isolating cost drivers behind material variances and writing the commentary that went to management.
- Prepared sections of the month reporting pack tracking operating expenditure against targets.
- Reviewed cost center structures and standard costing data to identify opportunities for improved resource allocation and operational efficiency.

Bank for Investment and Development of Vietnam (BIDV), Credit Analyst Intern

July 2024 – Sep 2024

- Analyzed 10+ client profiles (AUD 300k–420k exposure) producing the financial assessment supporting loan approval and risk grading.
- Contributed to the preparation of asset valuation reports across real estate and collateral-backed instruments, ensuring accuracy of underlying security assessments.
- Partnered with senior analysts to evaluate asset performance and identify emerging credit risks.
- Developed a strong working knowledge of lending structures, mortgage products, and credit risk frameworks applied within a commercial banking environment.

ACADEMIC PROJECT

FX Exposure & Hedging Case Study — Micron Technology (MU)

- Estimated Micron Technology's USD FX exposure by running CAPM and DXY-augmented regressions on monthly returns from Aug 2001 to Dec 2024, isolating market beta from currency beta.
- Analyzed Micron's operational currency exposure through its 10-K filings, mapping revenue and manufacturing footprint across Asian and US markets to support the empirical findings.
- Designed a hedging strategy using ICE US Dollar Index (DXY) futures, sizing contracts against a USD 1M equity position and modelling transaction costs across entry, exit, and futures P&L.

Markowitz & Single Index Model Portfolio Optimization

- Built minimum variance frontiers and identified Global Minimum Variance and Optimal Risky Portfolios for a 10-stock portfolio (ADBE, MCD, BLK, GOOGL, AMZN, MA, IBM, JPM, WMT, CVX) using monthly return data from 2014–2018, under both long/short and long-only constraints.
- Derived the Capital Allocation Line and computed the Optimal Complete Portfolio by maximizing utility under a personalized risk aversion coefficient, integrating risk-free and risky asset allocation decisions.
- Estimated CAPM-style regressions to obtain each stock's beta and idiosyncratic variance, then constructed a SIM-based variance-covariance matrix to re-derive efficient portfolios under the single-index assumption.

Top 5 @ BISA x UNSW WIT x Capgemini Case Competition

- Built the credit assessment and processing model underpinning the team's solution to a retail banking transformation brief.
- Owned the finance and cost section of the business case and built the full end-to-end front-end prototype.

AWARDS & CERTIFICATION

Certifications: Standard Chartered Credit Analyst Job Simulation, BCG Strategy Consulting Job Simulation, Goldman Sachs Internal Audit Job Simulation.

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Language: IELTS (Score: 8.0), Vietnamese (Native)

Skills:

- **Technical:** SQL, R, Tableau, Java, and Excel, Python
- **Finance:** DCF, Comparable Company Analysis, Budgeting, Hedging, Behavioural Finance.